

FAQs

Crawling computer

Q. I recently installed Windows 2000 Professional and Office XP on one partition, and Windows XP and Office XP on another. I have a Pentium 4 processor, 850 motherboard and 128 MB RD RAM. When I open Windows 2000, the response becomes slow, and after clicking the toolbar and opening Task Manager, I found Rscmpt.exe consuming 99 per cent, or more CPU time. Please tell me how to get rid of Rscmpt.exe.

GK Chakraborty

A. This is a known problem for nVidia display cards, but all you have to do to remedy it, is install the latest nVidia drivers. You can download them from www.nvidia.com.

Broadband on landline

Q. Recently, I have seen many advertisements about broadband on landlines (ADSL) from MTNL. What is the major advantage of this over others, and what is the minimum hardware requirement. Is it true that we can achieve speeds as fast as 256 Kbps on our landlines?

Siddharth Menon

A. Yes; you can achieve 256 Kbps, or even more on your phone line. The biggest advantage of ADSL is that you can even receive telephone calls while surfing the Internet, as the data is transferred on a different frequency,

which is inaudible. As far as the hardware is concerned, all you need is an ADSL modem, which your ISP will rent to you.

Monitoring the Internet

Q. I work as a network assistant in a company, and we have provided everyone with Internet access. The problem is that some of the staff misuses this facility. They download at will, and also visit indecent sites. How can I keep a check on them?

Zahir Ahmed

A. Since you haven't specified the software you're using to share the Internet connection, we'll have to solve your problem by assumption. If your Internet server is Windows-based, you should use proxy software such as WinProxy or Sygate. If your server is Linux-based, you can try qmail, which can give you monitoring capabilities after a few patches.

Create boot CD?

Q. How do I create a Red Hat Linux-9 bootable CD?

Sumeet Saha

A. There's a command in Red Hat called mkbootdisk that does this. Use it to create an ISO image of the bootable disk, and use cdrecord, Nero, etc, to create the bootable CD.

To create the ISO image, you'll need to know the kernel version—issue the '**ker-**

nelversion' command in a terminal window. Now verify that the folder with the version exists in **/lib/modules**. If you find that the folder name in **/lib/modules** is bigger than that specified by the '**kernelversion'** command, use the '**fullname'** switch instead.

To create the ISO image, issue the '**mkbootdisk --device boot.iso --verbose --iso <full kernel version>**' command. Once the ISO image is ready, burn it with the help of CD-recording software, and voila, you have a bootable CD!

Bad sectors

Q. When I try to install Windows XP, I get an error that says, "Setup has determined that drive C: is corrupted and cannot be repaired". The hard disk does contain some bad sectors. I have a Pentium 4 1.6 GHz, VIA VT8751 (P4M266) and Windows 98 SE. I have a Samsung hard disk with four partitions—C(37.2 GB), D(9.19 GB), E(9.19GB), and F(9.45 GB). What do I do?

Jarnail Singh

A. You need to ensure that the hard disk has bad sectors. Download and run the disk utility for this purpose by Samsung from www.samsung.com/Products/HardDiskDrive/utilities/hutil.htm. Execute the program, and let the utility test the hard drive. The program will tell you if the drive is usable or not. If not, then you have to get a new one.

and change its mode from LBA to normal. Now, let the PC boot up, run fdisk and delete the partitions. This done, go back to the BIOS, and change the mode back to LBA.

The notorious SM56 modem

Q. I have run Linux for over two years, from Red Hat 7.3 to Fedora Core 1. I can't install drivers for my modem—D-Link with a Motorola SM-56 chipset. I use kppp to dial my connection. What is the solution?

Naimish J. Makwana

A. Motorola provides universal modem drivers for all versions of Windows and Linux. They are available at www.motorola.com/softmodem/sm56_download.htm

Increase the power

Q. I have a Pentium II 333 MHz, a 440 ZX motherboard, 64 MB of RAM and a 6.4 GB hard drive. I want to upgrade the processor and memory. Can I do that on the same motherboard? In all, there are two memory slots, so how much memory can I add? Also, if I change my hard disk, what drive capacity will be supported?

Arvind

A. You are in a difficult position, to say the least.

First, the maximum processor upgrade that the 440 ZX motherboard will support is limited to one with a speed of 450 MHz. That is hardly an upgrade.

Secondly, the RAM you need should

be of the 66 or 100 MHz variety, which is very difficult to procure. These memory sticks are available in capacities of 64, 128, 256, and 512 MB.

As for your last query, the motherboard can support a 40 GB hard drive. ■



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E-mail us your computing problems, and we may answer them here!

Since we get more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!